

Swap essays with a partner for feedback.

A: Read your partner's introduction:

1. Is the introduction easy to read?
2. Is the introduction interesting?
3. Does the introduction make the aim of the essay clear (i.e. the research question) and indicate why it is important / interesting / relevant?
4. Does the introduction identify the writer's position (answer to the research question)?
5. Is an outline of the essay structure provided?
6. Is the overall length of the introduction appropriate?
7. Is there anything which you feel would improve the introduction?

B: Now read your partner's conclusion:

1. Is the conclusion clear and easy to read?
2. Does the conclusion restate the answer to the essay question?
3. Does the conclusion raise any other issues arising from the essay topic?
4. Is the overall length of the conclusion appropriate?
5. Is there anything which you feel would improve the conclusion?

C: Essay structure

1. Is the overall structure of the essay clear?
2. If not, how could it be improved:
 - a. Changes to the introduction/conclusion?
 - b. Use of sub-headings?
 - c. More 'sign-posting' language?
 - d. Other
3. Is the essay divided into paragraphs?

4. If yes, does each paragraph have a clearly identifiable theme which is well-developed?
5. Could the paragraphs be improved with regard to topic sentences and/or concluding sentences?

D: Content / Argumentation

1. Does the essay answer the essay question?
2. Is the content and argumentation clear?
3. Is the content interesting?
4. Is the content relevant? Are there any repetitions or irrelevancies?
5. Are arguments supported by evidence?

E: Referencing

1. Which form of referencing has been used: in-text or footnotes?
2. How many references are there?
3. Do the references in the essay match those in the bibliography?
4. Is there any information which should have been referenced but is not?
5. Can you spot any errors?

F: Language

1. In terms of language, is the essay easy to read? If not, why not?
2. Is the essay written in an academic style?
3. Are sentences a reasonable length (i.e. not too long)?
4. Can you detect any language errors?
5. Are there any words or phrases which you really like?